

Mobile World Congress 2010: It was Android all over the place

The blue-eyed boy of this year's Mobile World Congress—held in Barcelona from February 15-18, 2010—was indeed Android. Except for Microsoft, which showcased its new Windows Phone 7 series, most were busy showcasing their devices powered by Google's operating system -- the number of Android-powered devices was reportedly more than 50. The fact that Google CEO, Eric Schmidt, delivered a keynote speech at the conference, speaks for itself.

Taiwanese mobile manufacturer, HTC, announced its two new mobile phones—Legend and Desire, which are to support Flash for the first time. An updated version of Hero was also announced. Legend has somewhat similar features to Hero, with an 81.2 mm (3.2-inch) display and a slightly faster processor—600 MHz compared to the earlier 528 MHz. Instead of a plastic body, Legend uses a unique aluminium frame and replaces the mini trackball with an optical trackpad. However, the big one from HTC was, of course, Desire. This one borrows a number of features from the Google Nexus One: a 94 mm (3.7 inch) AMOLED display and a 1 GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon processor. Moreover, HTC adds the custom Sense UI to Android 2.1 and includes support for Flash 10.1.

Apart from HTC, Acer also updated its Liquid line up, with its new Acer Liquid E. This is basically an upgrade to Acer Liquid, which was priced at Rs 24,990 and powered by the older Android 1.6 OS. The new Liquid E will run on the latest

Android 2.1. The latest version offers a new keyboard layout with extended dictionary support, besides an updated browser with support for HTML 5. The Liquid E weighs only 135 grams and has dimensions of 115 x 62.5 x 12.5 mm. The phone runs on a Qualcomm Snapdragon 8250 processor clocked at 768 MHz, and offers an 88.9 mm (3.5-inch) touchscreen. Additionally, it packs in a 5 MP camera with auto focus. Acer also announced two new devices—beTouch E110 and the beTouch E400. These are entry-level handsets that run Android 1.5. The E110 offers a 71.1 mm (2.8-inch) screen, a 416 MHz processor and a 3MP camera. The E400 runs Android 2.1, a 600 MHz processor and a larger 81.2 mm (3.2-inch) screen.

Mobile phones apart, some companies also showcased new laptops and netbooks. As announced by Dell in CES 2010 in January, the Dell Mini tablet 5 will come with the Android 1.6 operating system along with a 127-mm (5-inch) touchscreen, 5MP camera and built-in Wi-Fi and 3G. HP showcased its Compaq Airline 100 smartbook that is powered by a 1 GHz Snapdragon processor, a 16 GB SSD hard disk, and lot more.

Well, we have only written about a fraction of the Android-based offerings that were on display. So visit www.mobileworldcongress.com/index.htm for more information.



Adobe enters LiMo

Adobe and the LiMo Foundation have announced that Adobe has joined the global consortium of mobile phone industry leaders to bring Flash to the LiMo platform. Support for Flash within the LiMo platform will enable developers and content providers to create applications that can run on LiMo devices. As a member of the LiMo Foundation, Adobe supports the development of an independent, collaboratively developed handset platform that is commercially driven by some of the largest operators and OEMs in the industry, including LG, NEC, NTT DOCOMO, Orange, Panasonic, Samsung, SK Telecom, Telefonica, Vodafone and Verizon Wireless.